

NOCTERNAL PLAYZ

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Everything the app can do and how to use it: your music, YouTube Music, Radio Hub, free downloads, the effects, lighting, themes and the AI assistant.

Version 1.0.0

Android (full) · iPhone (most features)

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STEP 0

Getting started

- 1 Install the APK. Unzip the download from GitHub, open the **.apk** file and allow **Install unknown apps** for your file manager if Android asks.
- 2 Open **Nocternal Play** and allow **music access** so it can find your songs. On Android 13 and newer, also allow **notifications** so playback controls show on the lock screen.
- 3 The app scans your phone. You'll see *Scanning your music...*, then *Analyzing BPM & key*. You can play music while it works.
- 4 Use the bottom bar to move between [Home](#) [Player](#) [Lighting](#) [Settings](#).

TIP

Songs added later show up after [Settings](#) ► [Library](#) ► [Rescan music](#).

HOME

Three sliding panels

The top of Home has three tabs. Tap one, or swipe left and right to slide between them:

- **Local**: the music on your phone, plus *Continue listening*, *AI ideas*, genre tiles and your library.
- **YouTube Music**: the YouTube Music website inside the app.
- **Radio Hub**: tens of thousands of internet stations and an FM-style dial.

While music plays, a **mini-player** sits above the bottom bar. Tap it to open the full player, or use its play/pause and next buttons. The glowing round button at the bottom right opens the [AI assistant](#).

On the Local panel

- **Continue listening**: tap a card to pick up where you were.
- **↓ Free music & podcasts**: opens [free downloads](#).
- **AI ideas**: tap a ✨ chip (such as a morning or focus playlist) and the assistant builds and plays it.
- **Genres**: 18 tiles. If you own songs in that genre, the tile says *N songs* and plays them. If not, it says *Radio* and opens matching stations.

HOME ▶ LOCAL ▶ LIBRARY

Your library

Use the chips under *Library* to switch views:

Songs

Every song, with BPM and musical key once analysed. Tap to play. ♥ marks favourites.

Playlists

Tap a playlist to drop down its songs. Tap  **Play** to play it all, or a song to start from there.

Folders

Browse your storage folders. Tap  **Play folder** to play everything inside;  goes up.

History

A day-by-day timeline of what you played and for how long. Nothing is recorded in private mode.

Smart playlists (made for you automatically)

- **Favorites**: songs you've liked with ♥ in the player.
- **Recently played** and **Most played**: skips don't count.
- **Mood** playlists, built from each song's detected mood.
- **Genre** playlists: one for each of the 18 genres, sorted using the song's genre tag, its folder name, then title/artist words, then tempo.

PLAYER TAB

The player

- Play/pause, next, previous and a seek bar. Shuffle and repeat (off → all → one).
- ♥ adds the song to Favorites.
- **Lyrics** button: shows synced lyrics (see [Lyrics](#)).

- **EQ:** opens [EQ & FX](#).
- **Sleep timer:** stop after 15, 30, 60 or 90 minutes, or at the end of the song. The music fades out gently.
- **Auto-mix** (DJ mode): picks the next song by matching BPM and key, so songs blend like a DJ set.
- Album art comes from the file. Songs without art get a generated neon cover.
-  collapses back to where you were.

Music keeps playing in the background, with controls on the lock screen, in notifications and on Bluetooth headsets.

PLAYER ▶ LYRICS

Lyrics

Lyrics scroll in time with the song and highlight the current line. They come from, in order:

1. A saved copy on your phone (works offline).
2. A **.lrc** file with the same name next to the song.
3. The free LRCLIB lyrics library online: exact match first, then a fuzzy search.
4. If no real lyrics exist, **AI-written lyrics**. With a Claude key they're written by Claude, otherwise on the phone. They're marked *AI-generated* and are original words inspired by the title and mood, not the real song. If real lyrics turn up later, they replace them.

PLAYER ▶ EQ

Equalizer & effects

- **10-band EQ** (31 Hz – 16 kHz) with 20 presets, such as *EDM punch*, *Lo-fi warm*, *Vocal clarity* and *Podcast voice*.
- **AI optimize:** picks EQ settings for the current song and for speaker vs headphones.
- **FX grid:** bass boost, 3D surround, stereo widening, loudness, pitch shift and vocal remover (karaoke).
- **Reverb, Compressor, Flanger, Phaser**, each with its own sliders.
- **Enhance** (AI song enhancer): clarity, noise removal, bass, vocal focus and old-recording restore.

TIP

Turn on [Settings ▶ Theme ▶ Theme also sets the EQ](#) and the EQ changes to suit each genre automatically.

Crossfade & gapless

With **Crossfade (next song overlaps, no gaps)** on, the next song starts before the current one ends, and the two blend smoothly. There's no silence between songs.

- Set the overlap with the slider (0–12 seconds). **4–6 s** suits playlists and mixes.
- Set **0 s** for live albums and DJ sets: songs join exactly, with no gap.
- **Smart audio normalization** evens out loudness so no song jumps out.
- **Speaker boost** makes the phone speaker louder. **Hearing & speaker safe mode** caps the peak volume.

On iPhone, songs play gapless back-to-back; the overlapping crossfade is Android only.

YouTube Music

This is the real YouTube Music website inside the app. Sign in with your Google account to get your playlists and likes. Search and play as usual; the neon theme changes with what you play.

Downloading from YouTube and blocking YouTube ads aren't included, because YouTube's terms don't allow it. For offline music, use [Free downloads](#).

Radio Hub

Free internet radio from open directories: **Radio Browser** (about 50,000 stations worldwide), **SomaFM** (ad-free channels) and the **Icecast** directory. Tap any station to play it.

By genre

The 18 app genres, plus the most popular tags. Add a country chip to narrow it down, e.g. Bollywood stations in India.

By country

All countries with flags and station counts. Type in *Find a country*, pick one, then filter by genre.

SomaFM

Listener-supported, commercial-free channels such as Groove Salad and Drone Zone.

FM dial

A tuning dial with FM stations from the chosen country that stream online, sorted by frequency.

The search box at the top searches every source at once.

HOME ► LOCAL ► FREE MUSIC & PODCASTS

Free downloads

Download music that is legal to keep. Everything here is Creative Commons or public domain, or a free podcast episode. Downloads play offline like your own songs.

Tabs

- **Internet Archive:** works without setup. Search, or tap a genre chip (electronic, ambient, lofi, rock, jazz, Indian...). Tap an album to see its songs.
- **Jamendo:** about 600,000 songs by independent artists. It needs a free client ID, set up once (below).
- **Podcasts:** search any show, or tap a starter chip (music, Bollywood, tech, comedy...). Tap a show to see its episodes.
- **Downloaded:** everything you've saved, with [Credit](#) and [Delete](#). Tap a song to play the whole list.

Download a song

- 1 Tap a song's title or picture to **stream a preview** first, if you like.
- 2 Tap [Get](#). A progress bar appears. [Cancel](#) stops it; [Retry](#) shows if it fails.
- 3 When it says ✓ **Saved**, the song is in your library under [Library](#) ► [Folders](#) ► [Free downloads](#), with lyrics, EQ, crossfade and themes like any other song.

Set up Jamendo (one time)

- 1 Go to **devportal.jamendo.com** and create a free account and app.
- 2 Copy its **Client ID**.
- 3 Paste it in [Settings](#) ► [Free music](#) ► [Jamendo client ID](#) and tap [Save client ID](#).

LICENCES

Every song shows its licence (for example *CC BY-SA 4.0*) and a *source* ↗ link. If you share or reuse a song, credit the artist; the app keeps a **CREDITS.txt** list of all your downloads. Licences with **NC** don't allow commercial use. For example, don't use them in a monetised YouTube video. Podcast episodes are for personal listening only.

Light bar & edge lighting

Light bar

A glowing bar that pulses with the music. Turn it on or off, pick a colour and set the glow strength.

Edge lighting

Neon light around the screen edges. Modes: **Static**, **Gradient** and **Music reactive**, with sliders for **thickness** and **brightness**.

Your settings are kept. Genre themes won't reset them. To let the theme choose again, tap [Follow genre theme again](#), or [Light bar: follow genre theme again](#) for the bar.

The 10 animations

- PulseWave Spectrum
- HyperBeam Edge Flow
- Aurora Ribbon
- BassShock Flash
- Prism Cycle
- Vortex Spiral
- EQ Bar Mirage
- Starfall Reactive
- Crystal Grid
- Infinity Loop

Also here: **Full-screen visualizer behind the player**, **Auto-switch theme by genre**, the **Neon theme presets** list (tap one to apply it) and [Resume automatic themes](#) after picking one by hand.

AUTOMATIC

Themes & genres

Each song's genre is detected. The whole look then changes to match: accent colours, glow, edge lighting, light-bar animation, background and optionally the EQ. You can also switch themes by mood (from the AI) or by time of day.

GENRE	THEME	LIGHTING
 Devotional	Sacred Gold Aura	Aurora Ribbon
 Meditation	Emerald Tranquility	Infinity Loop
 Sleep	Moonlit Cyan Drift	Aurora Ribbon
 Hindi Classics	Royal Purple Gold	Prism Cycle
 EDM	Electric Blue Pulse	PulseWave Spectrum
 Trance	Violet Hyperspace	Vortex Spiral
 Techno	Cyber Red Pulse	BassShock Flash
 Night Drive	Blue-Purple Galaxy	HyperBeam Edge Flow
 Lo-Fi	Soft Pink Glow	EQ Bar Mirage

 Chillout	Aqua Drift	Starfall Reactive
 Ambient	Deep Space Indigo	Crystal Grid
 Workout	Volt Lime Surge	BassShock Flash
 Focus	Laser Focus Teal	EQ Bar Mirage
 Romantic	Rose Neon Heart	Infinity Loop
 Party Mix	Rainbow Rave	PulseWave Spectrum
 Morning Vibes	Sunrise Amber	Aurora Ribbon
 Instrumental	Silver Strings	Crystal Grid
 Podcast Mode	Studio Mono Blue	EQ Bar Mirage

Theme modes ([Settings](#) ► [Theme](#)): **Light**, **Dark**, **Neon**, **AMOLED Black**. Pick your own accent colour, or leave it on **Auto (genre)**.

GLOWING ORB, BOTTOM RIGHT

AI assistant

Tap the orb, then type or tap the mic and speak. Commands like these work offline, with no key:

- “Play trance playlist”
- “Boost bass”
- “Activate meditation theme”
- “play something happy”
- “lofi bajao”
- “switch to radio”
- “skip”
- “remove the noise from this track”
- “explain what is gapless playback”

It can suggest playlists by genre, mood, BPM or time of day; recommend EQ settings; explain audio features; switch sources and run the enhancer.

Ask anything: add your own Claude API key in [Settings](#) ► [AI](#) for free-form chat and Claude-written lyrics. The key stays on your phone and is never included in backups.

What's this song? Music recognition listens through the mic. On Android it needs a free **audd.io** token in [Settings](#) ► [AI](#); on iPhone it uses Shazam.

SETTINGS TAB

Settings, section by section

SECTION	WHAT YOU CAN DO
Theme	Theme mode, accent colour, auto theme by genre / AI mood / time of day, and whether themes also set the EQ.
Playback	Crossfade on/off and overlap seconds.

Sound	Smart normalization, speaker boost, hearing & speaker safe mode.
Sleep timer	15 / 30 / 60 / 90 minutes, or Off.
Floating mini-player	Show bubble puts a draggable neon bubble over other apps (allow “display over other apps”); Hide removes it.
Privacy & offline	Private mode, smart offline mode, Use Wi-Fi , Use mobile data (both on by default; untick one to block it), auto-download lyrics, background downloads on Wi-Fi only, clear history.
AI	Claude API key, music recognition token.
Free music	Jamendo client ID.
Plugins	Turn on the built-in plugins: Scrobbler, Pomodoro focus timer, Beat counter.
Backup & restore	Save settings, playlists, favourites and history to a file. Restore with Merge or Replace , even on another phone or an iPhone.
Library	Rescan music after adding songs.

ALSO BUILT IN

More features

Smart offline mode

Without internet, online panels say so and your music, saved lyrics and downloads keep working.

Smart auto-download

Fetches lyrics for your most-played and recent songs in the background, on Wi-Fi if you choose.

Private mode

No history, no scrobbles and no online lyric lookups; history is left out of backups.

Mood detection

Guesses each song's mood to build Mood playlists and optionally change the theme.

BPM & key analysis

Measured on the phone and shown on each song. It powers DJ auto-mix.

Cosmic backgrounds

Nine animated backgrounds (starfield, nebula, aurora, grid horizon, rain glass...) chosen by the theme.

Plugins

Built-in add-ons that run safely. If one crashes, the app keeps playing.

Cross-platform backup

An Android backup restores on iPhone and the reverse. Songs are matched by artist, title and length.

IF SOMETHING'S OFF

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	TRY THIS
No songs	Allow music access in Android settings, then Settings ▶ Library ▶ Rescan music .
“You're offline”	Check Use Wi-Fi and Use mobile data in Settings ▶ Privacy & offline . If you're on mobile data, that box must be ticked.
A radio station won't play	Some stations go offline; try another. Search finds duplicates from other directories.
Jamendo tab asks for an ID	Add the free client ID (see Free downloads).
Lyrics say AI-generated	No real lyrics were found online. They're replaced when real ones appear.
Lighting keeps changing	Set it yourself on the Lighting tab; your values stay. Or turn off Auto-switch theme by genre .
Gap or dip between songs	Turn on Crossfade and set 4–6 s, or 0 s for gapless.
Bubble doesn't appear	Allow “Display over other apps” for Nocturnal Play in Android settings.

Nocturnal Playz by Roshan · Guide for app version 1.0.0 (Android build from the [claude/nocturnal-playz-music-app-vwjbn0](#) branch). Features marked Android-only: overlapping crossfade, free downloads, and the bubble over other apps.